

The Loneliest Girl: Score Drills

Section-by-section drills for your score: arr. Calary, easy and normal versions

How this works

Each unit is one section of your score. It looks at what those bars ask of each hand, splits that into separate skills, drills each skill on its own for a few days, then puts you straight back on the exact bars.

Keep the score open next to this book. Bar numbers refer to it, and nothing here reprints the arrangement. The notated examples are practice material built from the same ingredients: the same chords, the same kinds of rhythm, the same hand shapes.

Reading the tempo

The score's tempo mark is **56 quarter notes per minute** and is written in 16th notes. That's the same speed as the recording's 112, counted differently: four slots per beat, "**1 e & a**". Set the metronome to 56 (40 while learning a new passage). Each click is one beat.

The daily routine (5 minutes)

- 0:00–1:00** Count: clap two rhythm cells from your current unit.
- 1:00–3:00** One split drill (a, b, c or d). Rotate day by day.
- 3:00–5:00 The bars.** The last two minutes are always on the score.

With 10 minutes, repeat the bars from the previous unit as review.

Pencil on the score

Write in your printed score. Counts over tricky beats, fingerings on the first note of each phrase, a light vertical line wherever both hands play together. Each unit tells you what to mark.

Rules

Count out loud. Metronome ladder: 3 clean runs, add 4 BPM; two stumbles, drop 4. **Hands separately first,** always, even for bars you "almost" know.

Your score at a glance

Bars	Section	Chords (two per bar)	Unit
Easy version			
1–4	Intro	Em C G Bm, twice	3
5–12	Verse	Em C G Bm, four times	1
13–20	Chorus	C G Em D, four times; Cmaj7 in 17 and 20	2
20–22	Ending	Cmaj7 held into a 2/4 bar, final chord	3
Normal version (same melody and chords, new hand parts)			
23–26	Intro	as bars 1–4; bar 26 leads into bass clef	4
27–34	Verse	Em C G Bm; left-hand arpeggios	4
35–42	Chorus	C G Em D; two voices in the right hand	5
42–44	Ending	rolled chords, pause, final run	5

The units

#	Unit	Split into
1	Verse (5–12)	16th counting, chords with pedal, melody phrases, hands together
2	Chorus (13–20)	moving chord shapes, ledger lines, triplet, left-hand quarters
3	Intro & ending (1–4, 20–22)	sixths, 8va, tied notes, the 2/4 bar
4	Normal intro & verse (23–34)	bass clef, 16th arpeggios, octave melody
5	Normal chorus & ending (35–44)	two voices in one hand, wide left hand, rolls, the run

Why start with the verse

The verse has the simplest right hand (one note at a time) and the simplest left hand (one chord shape per half bar). The intro sounds easy but asks for two-note chords, ties and 8va reading all at once, so it comes third. Units 1–3 give you the whole easy version.

Typical path

Weeks 1–2: Unit 1. **Weeks 3–4:** Unit 2. **Week 5:** Unit 3, then the easy version start to finish. **Weeks 6–9:** Unit 4. **Weeks 10+:** Unit 5. The last page tracks it bar group by bar group.

Your earlier packet

Still useful as background: its Drill 2 (the six chords) for Units 1–3, Drill 6 (hands together) for Unit 2, Drill 5 (left hand) and Drill 8 (broken chords) for Unit 4. One correction: its Drill 3 says not to practise root-position chords, but the easy verse in your score uses exactly those.

Verse, bars 5–12 (easy)

UNIT

1

Eight bars, three new things: counting 16ths, chords with pedal, and a melody that starts after the beat.

Needs: nothing **New skills:** 16th notes, pedal, hands together **Gate:** L5

What's in these bars (score open beside you)

Right hand: the verse melody, one note at a time, mostly 16ths and 8ths. It stays roughly between the A in the second space and the F $\sharp$ on the top line, so one hand position with small stretches covers it. Most phrases start *after* a rest: on beat 1 the right hand is often silent.

Left hand: root-position triads, two per bar, half notes: Em C | G Bm, four times. G and Bm sit low, on ledger lines below the staff.

Pedal: the brackets under the staves are the sustain pedal, changed with every chord.

Before you start: compare bars 7 and 9. They begin the same way. Finding repeats first cuts the reading work.

1a Count in 16ths

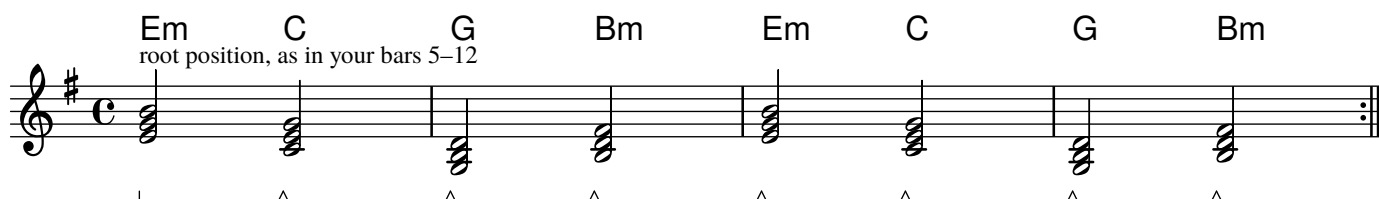


Every beat has four slots: **1 e & a**. Count all four out loud even when nothing plays on them. A rest is a slot you say but don't play.



Cells. Each cell is one beat long (c9 is two). These are the rhythm building blocks of the whole score. Clap each one 4 times at 56, counting. Then find them in bars 5–12 and write the cell number in pencil above each beat. Most beats are one of these nine.

1b The left hand as written



Fingers: 5-3-1 on every chord. The pedal: press as the chord sounds, then lift and press again exactly when the next chord sounds. You should hear no gap and no blur. G (G-B-D) and Bm (B-D-F $\sharp$) are the ledger-line chords; name their notes out loud until you stop counting lines.

1c The melody, one phrase at a time

The verse is four 2-bar phrases: **5–6, 7–8, 9–10, 11–12**. Learn one phrase every few days, in four steps. Don't skip to step 4.

Step 1 **Clap and count** the phrase's rhythm, using the cell numbers you pencilled in.

Step 2 **Say the note names** in rhythm, without playing.

Step 3 **Find the hand position.** Put the finger that fits on the phrase's first note and pencil its number in. Check the highest and lowest note fit without jumping.

Step 4 **Play** right hand alone at 40, then 48, then 56.

The 5 minutes

0:00–1:00

Cells. Two cells from 1a, 4 times each, counting aloud.

1:00–3:00

Split drill of the day: 1b on day 1, 1c on day 2, 1d on day 3 (next page), then repeat.

3:00–5:00

The bars. Today's phrase from 1c, hands separately, then hands together if it's ready.

Verse, bars 5–12: rejoin

UNIT

1

Where the hands meet, then the two hands together.

Needs: 1a–1c New skills: together points Gate: L5

1d Together points

Practice material: the verse chords under a right hand on one note, with the kinds of rhythm the verse uses. The chords always fall on beats 1 and 3. The right hand often comes in on the “&” or the “e”. Count out loud; the chord and your “one” land together.

In your score: draw a light vertical line through both staves at every left-hand chord (beats 1 and 3). At each line, ask: what is the right hand doing here? Often a rest, sometimes a note that starts with the chord. Those lines are the only places the hands have to agree.

Rejoin: back to your bars

- Skeleton.** Left hand plus only the right-hand notes that sit on a line. Slow, at 40.
- One phrase**, hands together, 40. Then the same phrase at 48.
- Chain two phrases:** 5–8, then 9–12. The bar lines between phrases are where people stop, so play over them without a break.
- Bars 5–12**, hands together. Then climb to 56.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 All nine cells clapped with counts	56	_____
☐ L2 Left hand, bars 5–12, with pedal, no stops	56	_____
☐ L3 Right hand, phrases 5–6 and 7–8	40	_____
☐ L4 Right hand, bars 5–12	48	_____
☐ L5 Gate. Hands together, bars 5–12	44	_____
☐ L6 Same at the written tempo	56	_____
☐ L7 Bars 5–12 along with the recording's verse	record	_____

Make it harder

Play bars 5–12 without pedal and keep the chords connected with your fingers. Then with pedal again: hear the difference. Say the counts out loud while playing hands together.

If it falls apart

Rhythm wrong: back to 1a and clap the phrase. Chord slow to find: 1b alone, or Drill 2 of your earlier packet. Hands collide: step 1 of the rejoin, at 40.

Chorus, bars 13–20 (easy)

UNIT

2

New chord shapes that barely move, a higher melody, and a left hand that pulses in quarters.

Needs: Unit 1 L5 **New skills:** moving shapes, ledger lines above, triplet, LH quarters **Gate:** L5

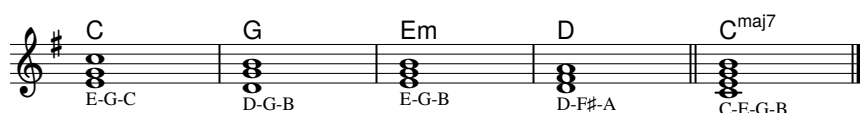
What's in these bars (score open beside you)

Left hand: no longer root position. C, G, Em and D are voiced so the hand stays in one place (the shapes below). Bars 13, 17 and 19 are half notes; in 14–16, 18 and 20 some chords repeat as quarter notes, so the left hand pulses on the beat. Bars 17 and 20 use **Cmaj7** (C-E-G-B), C major with B on top.

Right hand: higher than the verse, up onto the ledger lines above the staff. The same short rhythm keeps coming back: find it in bar 13 and look for it everywhere else. Bar 16 has a **triplet**.

Repeats: compare 13–16 with 17–20 before you learn anything.

2a The chorus hand shapes



C → G: E down to D, C down to B, G stays.

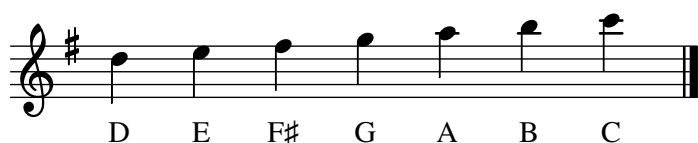
Em → D: all three notes step down.

Cmaj7: root-position C plus finger 5 on B.

Fingers: 1-2-5 for E-G-C, 1-3-5 for the rest;

Cmaj7 1-2-3-5.

2b Ledger lines above the staff



Count up from the top line (F#): G sits just above it, A is on the first ledger line, B sits above that, C is on the second ledger line. Quiz: point at any note in bars 13–20 and name it within 2 seconds.

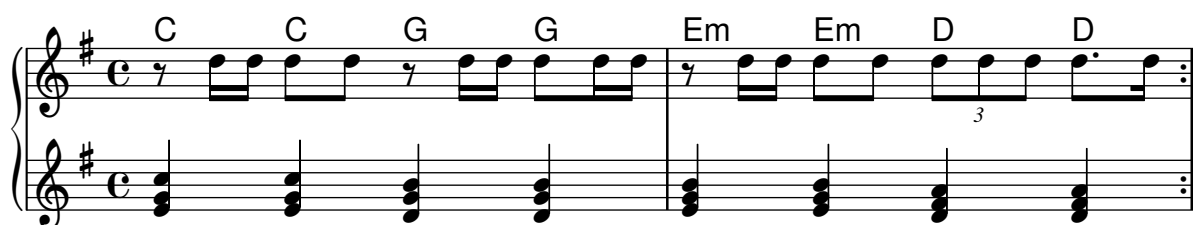
2c New cells



c10 is the triplet: three even notes in one beat.

Say "tri-po-let". Pencil the cell numbers above bars 13–20, as in Unit 1.

2d Left-hand quarters under a busy right hand



Practice material on one note. The left hand plays on every beat now, so it lines up with the right hand four times per bar, not two.

Rejoin: back to your bars

- Left hand, bars 13–20, with pedal. Then right hand in 2-bar phrases (13–14, 15–16, 17–18, 19–20), using the 1c steps.
- Hands together per phrase at 40, then chain them. Then **verse into chorus**: bars 11–14, over the join.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 Left hand, bars 13–20, with pedal	56	_____
☐ L2 Ledger-note quiz: any note in 13–20 in 2 seconds	—	_____
☐ L3 Right hand, bars 13–16	44	_____
☐ L4 Right hand, bars 13–20	48	_____
☐ L5 Gate. Hands together, bars 13–20	44	_____
☐ L6 Verse and chorus, bars 5–20	50	_____
☐ L7 Bars 5–20 at the written tempo	56	_____

Make it harder

Make the melody louder than the left-hand chords: the chorus is where the tune has to sing. Play bars 13–20 with the left hand an octave lower.

If it falls apart

Hands collide on the quarters: 2d at 40, then Drill 6 (S2) of your earlier packet. Lost on ledger lines: 2b daily for a week.

Intro and ending, bars 1–4 and 20–22 (easy)

Two notes at once in the right hand, an octave higher than written. After this unit you have the whole easy version.

UNIT

3

Needs: Unit 1 L5 **New skills:** sixths, 8va, tied notes, a 2/4 bar **Gate:** L5

What's in these bars (score open beside you)

Right hand: two notes at a time, mostly **sixths**, under an **8va** line: play everything under the dashed line one octave higher than written, until the line ends after bar 4. Lots of ties: a note starts before the beat and holds across it, so the beat itself is silent (the same idea as the push in your earlier packet).

Left hand: the same root-position chords as the verse. You know it already.

Repeats: bars 3–4 repeat bars 1–2. You're learning two bars, not four.

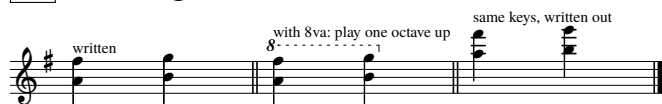
Ending: the Cmaj7 in bar 20 is tied through bar 21, which has only 2 beats (2/4), then bar 22 holds the final chord.

3a Sixths in G major



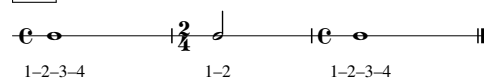
Keep the hand shape fixed and move the whole hand one step at a time. Listen for the warm sound. It's a thirds drill too: a sixth is a third turned upside down.

3b Reading 8va



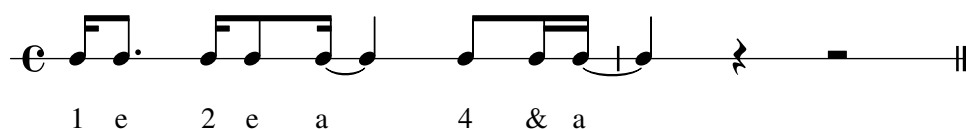
Read the note names as written, then move your hand up one octave. Pencil "8va up!" at the start of bar 1.

3c The 2/4 bar



Bar 21 has two beats. Count "1–2" and move on; the final chord comes early.

3d Tied notes



Clap only where a new note starts; a tie means hold, don't replay. Count every slot aloud. When a note is tied over a beat, you'll feel the urge to play on the beat. Don't.

Rejoin: back to your bars

1. Right hand, bars 1–2 in the right octave: top notes only first, then both notes.
2. Hands together 1–2, then 1–4, then 1–6: the intro into the verse. Then the ending, bars 19–22.
3. **The whole easy version**, bars 1–22.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 Sixths up and down, one octave, right hand	60	_____
☐ L2 3d clapped with counts	56	_____
☐ L3 Right hand, bars 1–2, at the right octave	40	_____
☐ L4 Right hand, bars 1–4	48	_____
☐ L5 Gate. Hands together, bars 1–6 (intro into verse)	44	_____
☐ L6 Ending, bars 19–22, hands together	44	_____
☐ L7 The easy version , bars 1–22, no stops	56	_____

Make it harder

Play the intro's top notes only while your left hand plays; that's your melody check. Play bars 1–22 along with the recording.

If it falls apart

Wrong octave or lost place: pencil the 8va reminder. Ties get replayed: 3d at 40. Sixths feel wide: 3a daily, hands alone.

Normal version: intro and verse, bars 23–34

UNIT

4

Same melody, new hands: 16th arpeggios in the left hand, a fuller right hand.

Needs: Unit 3 L7 **New skills:** bass clef, 16th arpeggios, octave melody, clef changes **Gate:** L5

What's in these bars (score open beside you)

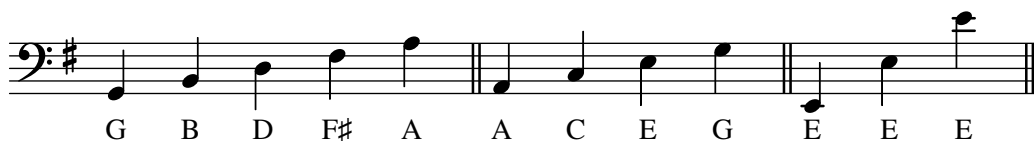
Bars 23–25 are bars 1–3 again. **Bar 26** adds a left-hand chord and a quick three-note pickup, and the left hand switches to **bass clef**.

Left hand, 27–34: 16th-note arpeggios, one per chord, two chords per bar. Each climbs from a low root through the chord and back, spanning more than an octave. Bar 34 climbs back up into treble clef as a run into the chorus.

Right hand, 27–34: the verse melody from bars 5–12, with some notes doubled in octaves and chord notes added.

Clefs: the left hand changes clef in bars 26, 34 and 36. Circle each change.

4a Bass clef landmarks



Lines from the bottom: G B D F# A. Spaces: A C E G. Learn the three Es; the verse arpeggios start from them.

4b The arpeggio shape



Practice material with the same hand motion as your score: root, fifth, octave, tenth, and back. Fingers 5-2-1 for root-fifth-octave, then shift or stretch for the tenth. Pencil your score's fingering in once this feels natural. Change the pedal with every chord.

4c Octaves



Thumb and pinky, wrist loose, hand shape fixed.

4d Build the right hand in layers



In bars 27–34: top notes only first (the melody you know from Unit 1), then the octaves, then the chord notes.

Rejoin: back to your bars

1. Left hand alone, bars 27–30, at 40. Name the root of each arpeggio before you play it.
2. Right hand in layers (4d), bars 27–30. Then hands together, 2 bars at a time.
3. Bars 31–34 the same way, then **23–34**, including the clef change in bar 26.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 Bass-clef quiz: any left-hand note in 27–34 in 2 seconds	—	_____
☐ L2 4b round the verse chords, even 16ths	44	_____
☐ L3 Left hand, bars 27–34	44	_____
☐ L4 Right hand, bars 27–34, all layers	48	_____
☐ L5 Gate. Hands together, bars 27–30	40	_____
☐ L6 Bars 23–34 hands together	48	_____
☐ L7 Same at the written tempo	56	_____

Make it harder

Accent the lowest note of each arpeggio slightly: it's the bass line. Record the left hand alone and listen: are the 16ths even?

If it falls apart

Arpeggio uneven: 4b at 40, or Drill 8 of your earlier packet. Lost in bass clef: 4a daily. Hands together too much: keep the right hand to top notes only for a week.

Normal version: chorus and ending, bars 35–44

UNIT

5

Two parts in one hand, a wide left hand, rolled chords and a final run.

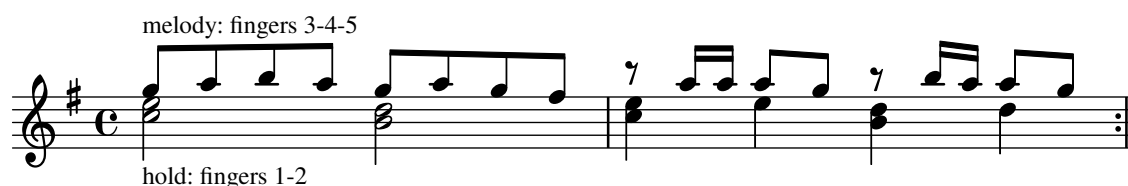
Needs: Unit 4 L5 **New skills:** two voices, octaves and tenths, rolls, free time **Gate:** L5

What's in these bars (score open beside you)

Bars 35–36 are close to the easy chorus (13–14). **From bar 37** the right hand carries two parts: the melody (stems up) and held chord notes (stems down). "R.H" marks the notes it takes. The left hand plays wide intervals in bass clef, octaves and larger, mostly as half notes. **Bar 38** has the triplet from bar 16.

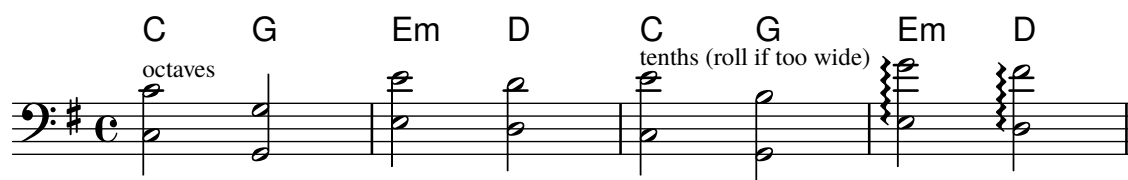
Ending: bar 42 has **rolled chords** (the wavy lines) in both hands, bar 43 a **pause** (fermata), and bar 44 a fast rising run over a G chord before the last low note.

5a Two voices in one hand



Hold the lower notes with fingers 1-2 for their full length while 3-4-5 play the melody. If a held note drops early, the chord disappears. In your score, play the stems-up line alone first, then add the stems-down notes.

5b Wide left hand



Octaves: fingers 5 and 1. Tenths may be too wide for your hand: roll them (bottom, then top) or leave out the top note. Both are normal.

5c Rolled chords



Bottom to top, quickly, both hands as one gesture. The top note lands on the beat.

5d The final run



Learn it slowly as a broken chord, then speed up. Bars 43–44 are in free time: arriving on the top note matters more than speed.

Rejoin: back to your bars

1. Left hand, 37–42. Right hand, 37–38 stems-up only, then both voices. Then 39–42.
2. Hands together, 2 bars at a time, then **35–42**. Then the ending **42–44**, then **the whole normal version**.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 5a clean, held notes full length	56	_____
☐ L2 Left hand, bars 37–42	48	_____
☐ L3 Right hand, bars 37–38, both voices	40	_____
☐ L4 Right hand, bars 37–42	44	_____
☐ L5 Gate. Hands together, bars 35–42	44	_____
☐ L6 Ending, bars 42–44, with roll, pause and run	free	_____
☐ L7 The normal version, bars 23–44	56	_____

Make it harder

Play the whole score, easy then normal, as one 44-bar piece. Bring the melody out over the held notes in 37–41.

If it falls apart

Two voices blur: 5a with the lower voice only, then add the top. LH stretch hurts: roll it or drop the top note. Rushing the ending: count the pause out loud.

Bar Tracker

Tick each box when that bar group is clean 3 times in a row. Hands separately first, then together, then at 56.

Bar groups

Bars	Section	Unit	RH	LH	Together	At 56	Notes / date
5–8	Verse, first half	1	☐	☐	☐	☐	
9–12	Verse, second half	1	☐	☐	☐	☐	
13–16	Chorus, first half	2	☐	☐	☐	☐	
17–20	Chorus, second half	2	☐	☐	☐	☐	
1–4	Intro	3	☐	☐	☐	☐	
20–22	Ending	3	☐	☐	☐	☐	
23–26	Normal intro	4	☐	☐	☐	☐	
27–30	Normal verse, first half	4	☐	☐	☐	☐	
31–34	Normal verse, second half	4	☐	☐	☐	☐	
35–38	Normal chorus, first half	5	☐	☐	☐	☐	
39–42	Normal chorus, second half	5	☐	☐	☐	☐	
42–44	Normal ending	5	☐	☐	☐	☐	

Performances

Each is a complete run without stopping. Record it on your phone; listening back is the fastest feedback there is.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row	
☐ P1 Easy verse and chorus, bars 5–20	44 _____
☐ P2 The easy version, bars 1–22	56 _____
☐ P3 The easy version with the recording	record _____
☐ P4 The normal version, bars 23–44	44 _____
☐ P5 The normal version at the written tempo	56 _____
☐ P6 The whole score, bars 1–44	56 _____

Unit log (write the date when you tick a level)

Unit	L1	L2	L3	L4	L5	L6	L7
1 Verse							
2 Chorus							
3 Intro & ending							
4 Normal intro & verse							
5 Normal chorus & ending							